

Stress & Mental Health

Feeling overwhelmed, anxious, or down? Support is available — from free counseling to low-cost therapy and self-help tools. You don't need to be in crisis to ask for help. Below are trusted national starting points.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

If you're in crisis right now, call or text 988. Otherwise, the resources below help you find ongoing, affordable mental health support. Most health insurance and Medicaid cover mental health care.

1 Find Affordable Therapy & Counseling

Free and low-cost mental health care exists — including sliding-scale clinics that charge based on income.

- ☐ **FindSupport.gov**
A government guide to finding the right mental health support and understanding your options.
→ www.findsupport.gov
- ☐ **FindTreatment.gov**
Search for low-cost and sliding-scale mental health and substance-use providers near you.
→ www.findtreatment.gov
- ☐ **Community Mental Health Centers (SAMHSA)**
Find federally supported centers that provide care regardless of ability to pay.
→ www.samhsa.gov/find-help

2 Free Support Groups

Peer support from people who understand — free and available across the country and online.

- ☐ **NAMI — National Alliance on Mental Illness**
Free support groups, education, and a helpline for people and families. Call or text the NAMI Helpline.
→ www.nami.org/help 1-800-950-6264
- ☐ **Mental Health America — Find Support**
Free screening tools and a directory of local affiliates and support.
→ www.mhanational.org/finding-help

3 Free Self-Help Tools

Trusted, no-cost tools for managing stress, anxiety, and low mood between appointments.

- ☐ **Mindfulness, CBT & VA Mental Health Apps**
The VA's free, public mental health apps (like Mindfulness Coach and CBT-i Coach) are free to anyone, not only veterans.
→ mobile.va.gov/appstore/mental-health
- ☐ **CDC — Coping With Stress**
Plain, trustworthy guidance on managing stress and protecting your mental health.
→ www.cdc.gov/mental-health/living-with/index.html

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Be cautious of apps or sites promising to “cure” anxiety or depression with special sound frequencies, supplements, or paid programs — these aren’t proven. Stick to licensed providers and the trusted nonprofits above.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Ask your doctor or insurance about covered mental health visits — many plans include several free or low-cost sessions. A primary care doctor can also be a good first step and refer you onward.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need ongoing local support?

This guide covers national starting points. For therapists, support groups, and low-cost clinics near you — including sliding-scale options — use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we’ll help you find the right fit.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
